COMMUNICATION

Objectives:

At the end of this lecture, each student will be able to:

Define communication

Identify importance of communication

Describe factors affecting communication

Explain elements of communication

Understand characteristics of successful communication

Discuss communication barriers/blocks

Describe how to improve communication skills

Definition:

Communication is the process of exchanging ideas, feeling, attitude, believe and meaning between two or more individuals. It is a two-way process is an ongoing, dynamic & ever-changing series of events. It is the mechanisms, by which people establish, maintain & improve their human contacts.

Importance of communication:

Communication is one of our basic needs to express feeling that is why it is emphasized in psychiatric nursing.

Communication is first step in relating to others.

Failure to communication is one of the main problems in mental, pt communicating with them could reeducate them in that aspect.

It helps the nurse to identify, assess & meeting the patients needs.

Therapeutic Communication:

Sometimes called effective communication, it is purposeful and goal-oriented, creating a beneficial outcome for the client.

Goals of Therapeutic Communication:

To obtain or provide information

To develop trust

To show caring

To explore feelings

Factors affecting communication:

Communication is usually affected by three main variables

1. Perception

This refers to the experience of seeing, feeling, interpreting, and understanding the world in which a person lives.

2. Values

It influences the process of communication, as people value what is worth to them.

3. Culture

It teaches people how to communicate through language, hand gestures, clothing & even the way they use the space around them.

Elements of communication:

To communication to occur, the following elements are necessary

The sender or the person conveying the information, idea or feelings.

The message or what must be transmitted.

The receiver this is one or more person for whom the message is given.

The method (channel) or means of conveying the message (talking, writing, acting).

A response or a feed backs.

Common language.

Modes or types of communication:

Communication can be grouped into two main types

1. Verbal communication

This means the use of language to language convey a massage transmitted through the spoken or written words. It needs the ability to be good listener and elicit the real meaning of the words.

2. Nonverbal communication

This includes

Body movement:

It is the most used categories are facial expression, gestures, eye movements & body postures.

Voice quality & non language sounds:

It refers the volume & rate of speech, the tone pitch and range of voice. Examples of non-language sounds include laughing, granting.

Personal & social space:

It refers to the dimensions of territoriality & interpersonal space.

Touch:

It is an important channel of communication if properly used.

Cultural artifacts:

These include clothes, cosmetics, jewelry.

N.B: Non-verbal communication is a more reliable means of expression of true feelings as there is less conscious control over it

Characteristic of successful communication:

Communication can only be successful when the person has a feeling of being understood. This depends up on the presence of four characteristics:

Feed back

This is the return response of the receiver. It indicates the effect made by the message received.

Appropriateness

This means that messages are relevant to the present situation & each part is fitting.

Flexibility

This means the absence of over control or under control. Over control is present when these are checking of communication exchange & prescription of ones response. Under control exists when participants do and say as they want.

Efficiency

This means that the language used by the communication is clear, simple and well timed. The message is being understood & there is enough time to perceive & evaluate the message.

Communication Techniques:

Talking techniques.

Non-taking techniques.

Talking techniques:

Broad openings

Such as what are you thinking about? Can you tell me more about that? What would you like to talk about today? And then what happened? I follow you.

This encourage patient to select topics to discuss, they can show acceptance & prove that the nurse is listening and following.

b Open-ended statement

This technique is useful in referring to a topic you would like to hear more about e.g. you went to the occupational therapy.

c Questioning

This is a very direct way of speaking. Avoid questions that are answered by one word.

EX. Are you ...?

d Restating

Here the nurse is repeating to the patient the main thought he has expressed. Sometimes only a part of the patient statement is repeated. This can serve to bring attention to something important.

e Clarification

The nurse puts into wards vague ideas or thoughts that are implicit or explicit by the patients talk. e.g., I'm not sure you mean. Are you saying that?

f - Focusing

This helps patient expand on a topic & allows him to discuss central issues.

g Paraphrasing

It tests the nurse's understanding of what patient is trying to communicate.

EX. In other words...

h Summarizing

It is a way of high lighting the main ideas that have been discussed.

J Linking

Tying together two events, experiences & feelings. e.g., linking is used to connect past experiences with present behavior e.g. Do you think the trouble is more with him or with you since you both have been under increased stress?

K Comment

Appropriate comment indicates attentiveness and interest and helps the pt to continue. EX. O.K., YES.

Non-talking techniques

A Listening

Listening implies that one person is talking & the other is silent. The silent person is being alert, active, attentive & interested in what is being said.

Listening is an active process & is not just passive hearing. It is important task for a nurse.

Importance of listening

It provides the opportunity for the patient to take the communication lead.

It conveys respect & interest to the patient.

It reinforces verbalization by the patient.

It helps the patient express his feelings & relieve some of his inner tension.

It helps the patient to feel that he is important.

It is essential for the nurse to reach any understanding of the patient.

B- Silence

In this technique both sender & receiver are not talking. It is an essential technique used to further the therapeutic relationship. During the period of silence, the nurse must communicate interest and involvement.

Silence may provide an opportunity for both partners to think about what has been said, to organize their thoughts, to consider alternative actions, to prepare for further response & to evaluate effect of the on each other.

Blocks of communication:

Changing the subject of communication.

Giving quick, false, and /or reassurance.

Stating one's personal- opinion & ideas.

Defensive reflex.

Closed questions.

Jumping to conclusion.

Judgmental responses.

Offering rapid solution to problems.

Making in appropriate use of professional knowledge.

How to improve communication:

Accept the pts mode of communication; show him respect, interest, understanding and warmth.

Used language that is appropriate to the pt's level of understanding.

Select topics of interest to the patient.

Minimize your verbal participation, so that the pt will have the chance to lead the conversation.

Give suggestions as indicated.

Allow individuals to express their negative feelings.

Accept periods of silence.